



Sofija Hotomski

Product professional

Product manager and hands-on product builder with 15 years of experience across SaaS, mobile applications, distributed systems, AI-powered products and customer-facing product delivery. PhD in Computer Science. I combine strong product ownership with technical understanding, requirements engineering and a practical “build, test, learn” mindset. I bring a strong background in translating customer and field needs into clear requirements, aligning engineering, UX, sales and leadership, and delivering products that work reliably in real-world environments.

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WORK EXPERIENCE

● Founder & AI Product Lead

Self-employed/HoloMost/StrongME

www.holomost.com

Jun, 2025 - Present | Zurich, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Founded and built two businesses across digital and in-person markets: [HoloMost](#), the company behind the AI-powered [HoloPal](#) platform, and [StrongME](#), a community-based fitness concept.
- Owned the complete product lifecycle across both ventures, including customer discovery, problem validation, product strategy, roadmaps, requirements engineering, MVP delivery, user testing, pricing, partnerships, go-to-market and feedback-driven iteration.
- Took HoloPal from concept to a live beta selected for Web Summit's ALPHA programme and StrongME from concept to weekly paid classes generating over 1,500 CHF from April 2026.
- Led and launched Isca, a paid commercial AI product for [International School Community](#), from problem definition through launch and iteration; it makes 55,000+ teacher reviews accessible to a 44,000-member community and handles 100+ questions daily.
- Earned the Certified AI-Empowered SAFe Product Owner/Product Manager (POPM) certification in July 2026.

● Global Product Manager

Siemens AG

Jan, 2022 - Jun, 2025 | Zug, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Led the end-to-end transformation of a traditional fire safety management system into a cloud-based SaaS solution, [BX Fire Manager and Fire Connect App](#), aligning engineering, UX, sales, marketing, regional stakeholders and leadership across markets; achieved a 35% global replacement rate, including 80% adoption in the Netherlands.
- Owned cross-functional delivery across web, mobile, API, cloud and migration workstreams, translating business goals and customer needs into requirements, priorities and delivery plans.
- Acted as the bridge between senior leadership, customer-facing teams and distributed engineering teams, providing structured updates on progress, risks, dependencies and tradeoffs to support decision-making.
- Worked closely with engineering teams to clarify requirements, manage dependencies, validate scope and support timely delivery within agreed constraints.
- Coordinated global rollout activities, including releases, documentation, internal communication, migration planning and go-to-market readiness across regions.
- Used adoption results, customer and field feedback, and delivery insights to prioritize improvements, manage risks and dependencies and align stakeholders on product decisions and trade-offs.



WORK EXPERIENCE

● Senior Requirements Engineer/Project Lead

ASMIQ AG (Swiss Post)

May, 2019 - Jul, 2021 | Zurich, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Served as the primary bridge between executive stakeholders and technical teams, translating business goals into clear requirements, priorities and implementation-ready specifications.
- Led requirements discovery through interviews, workshops and review sessions, ensuring shared understanding across business, engineering and decision-making stakeholders.
- Coordinated a remote team of six developers delivering CRM and e-commerce platforms for European markets, managing priorities, dependencies and delivery expectations.
- Provided regular roadmap updates, risk assessments and status reports to leadership to support alignment and informed decision-making.
- Facilitated demos, reviews and working sessions to validate progress, incorporate feedback and keep delivery closely connected to business needs.

● Researcher and Teaching Assistant for Requirements and Software Engineering

University of Zurich

Apr, 2015 - May, 2019 | Zurich, Switzerland

Achievements/Tasks

- Conducted applied research in Requirements Engineering research group, developing and evaluating [GuideGen](#), an AI (NLP-based) approach to align evolving requirements and acceptance tests.
- Coordinated academic-industry research collaborations with 15 international companies, including requirement elicitation, feedback collection and validation of research outcomes in real-world contexts.
- Organized and facilitated research workshops, review sessions and presentations with academic and industry stakeholders.
- Designed and delivered university courses in Requirements Engineering and Software Engineering, including preparation of materials, coordination of student projects and supervision of individual and group work.
- Authored and published peer-reviewed research papers, presenting results at international conferences to both technical and practitioner audiences.
- Since 2015 and up to day I correct REquirements engineering exam honorarily in my free time.

● SCADA Product Lead

Schneider Electric DMS

Feb, 2012 - Mar, 2015 | Novi Sad, Serbia

Achievements/Tasks

- Served as a customer-facing technical lead for enterprise SCADA/DMS systems, real-time, distributed platforms built on continuous telemetry ingestion, translating complex operational requirements into scalable product solutions for global utility customers.
- Traveled internationally to engage with key stakeholders and customers, presenting state-of-the-art solutions, eliciting requirements for customizations and building strong, trustful relationships.
- Translated high-level business goals into actionable product requirements.
- Coordinated with cross-functional engineering teams to prioritize requirements, clarify scope and support delivery of tailored product capabilities.
- Applied strong domain understanding of telemetry-driven, mission-critical systems to bridge customer expectations, technical constraints and product delivery.



WORK EXPERIENCE

● Software Engineer

DMS Group (Siemens)

Oct, 2010 - Feb, 2012 | Novi Sad, Serbia

Achievements/Tasks

- Developed backend, database and presentation-layer components for large-scale SCADA/DMS applications used in enterprise utility environments.
- Implemented business logic, stored procedures and UI functionality using C#, .NET, WPF, PL/SQL, SQL and Oracle DBMS.
- Worked closely with senior engineers and project leads to implement, test and document features in a complex distributed system environment.
- Supported system integration activities and contributed to technical documentation for customer-facing delivery.



EDUCATION

● PhD in Computer Science

University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland

Apr, 2015 - Mar, 2019 | Grade: summa cum laude

● MSc in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Faculty of Technical Sciences, University of Novi Sad, Serbia

Oct, 2010 - Dec, 2011 | Grade average: 10/10

● BSc in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Faculty of Technical Sciences, University of Novi Sad, Serbia

Oct, 2006 - Sep, 2010 | Grade average: 8.4/10



LANGUAGES

English: C2

Native or Bilingual Proficiency

German: B2/C1

Full Professional Proficiency

Serbian: Native

Native or Bilingual Proficiency



SKILLS

Product & Project Management Requirements Engineering Stakeholder Alignment Roadmap Execution

Risk and Dependency Management Cloud-based SaaS Cross-functional Delivery RAG-based systems

LLM API integration (OpenAI, Anthropic Claude) Multi-modal AI (connecting voice, avatar, text pipelines)

Vector embeddings & semantic search Observability Enterprise, Large-scale & Distributed Systems

Java, C#, .NET, WPF, SQL, PL/SQL, Oracle DBMS, React, vector databases VS Code, Copilot, Claude

Jira, Confluence, RTC